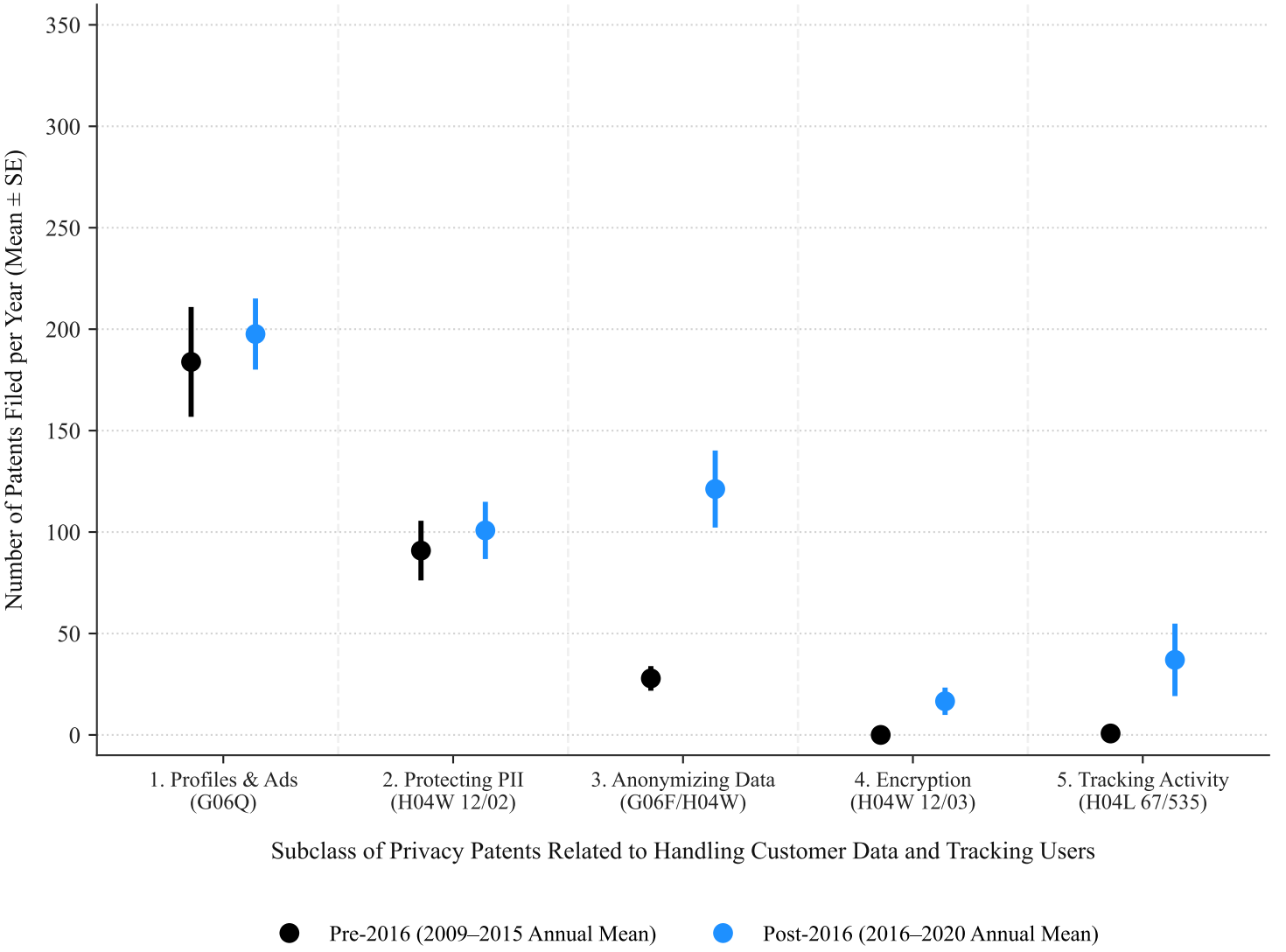
Number of Patents Filed per Year (Mean ± SE)
350
300
250
200
150
100
50
0
1. Profiles & Ads (G06Q)
2. Protecting PII (H04W 12/02)
3. Anonymizing Data (G06F/H04W)
4. Encryption (H04W 12/03)
5. Tracking Activity (H04L 67/535)
Subclass of Privacy Patents Related to Handling Customer Data and Tracking Users
Pre-2016 (2009–2015 Annual Mean)
Post-2016 (2016–2020 Annual Mean)